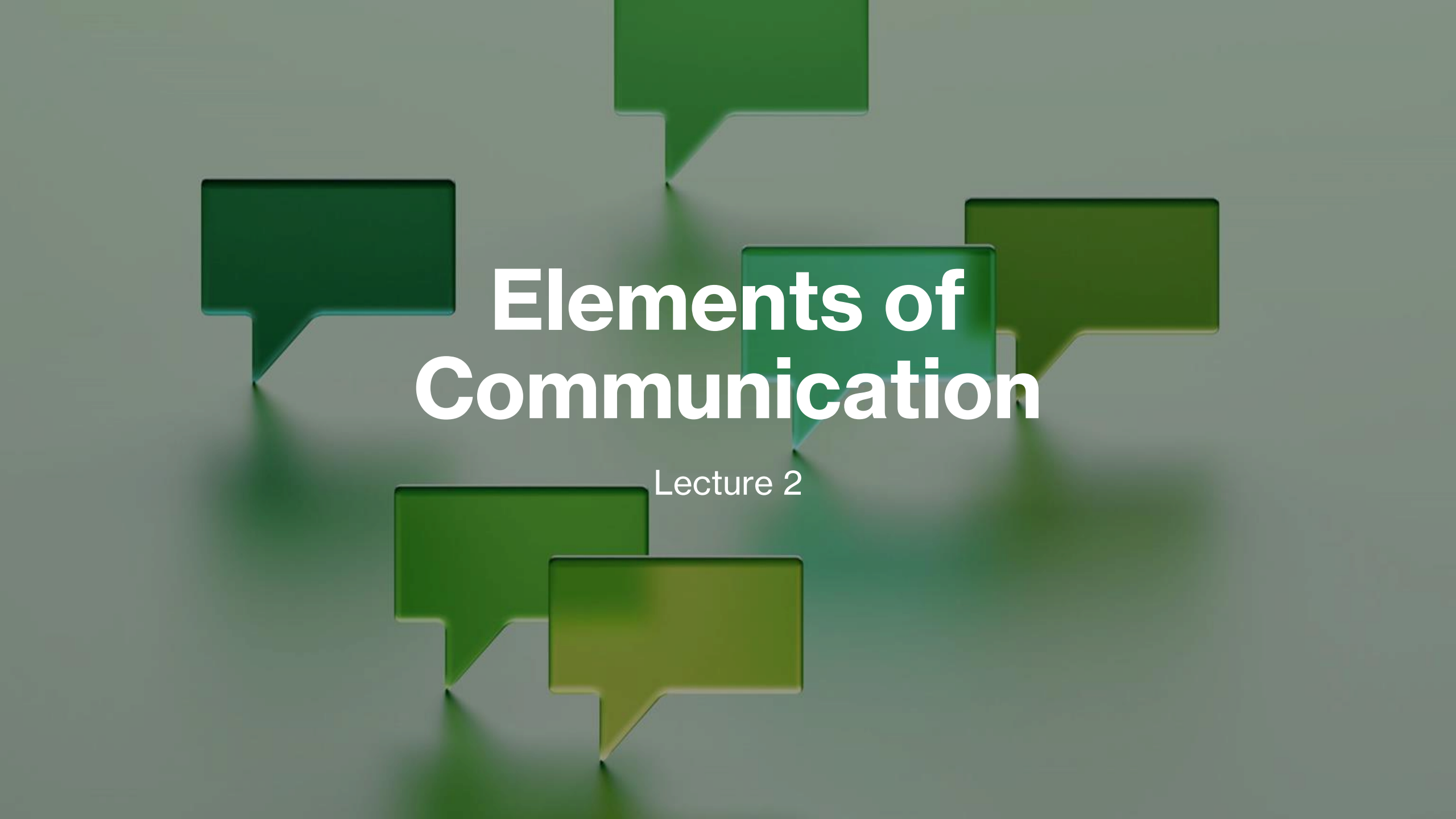


The background of the slide is a solid light green color. Scattered across the background are several 3D-style speech bubbles in various shades of green, including dark green, medium green, and light green. These bubbles are positioned at different angles and depths, creating a sense of movement and communication. The main title is centered over this background.

Elements of Communication

Lecture 2

Communication Vs. Effective Communication

The difference between communication and effective communication lies in the **clarity** and **understanding** of the message.



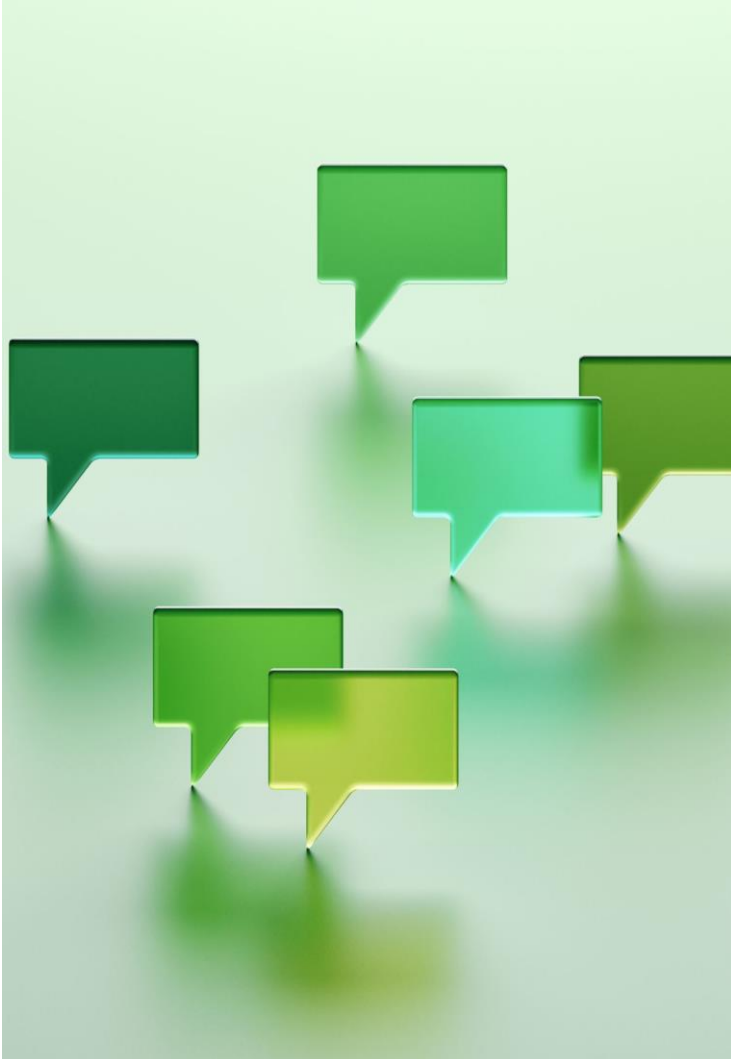
Communication is simply the flow of information from the sender to the receiver, regardless of whether the recipient understands the message.



Effective communication, on the other hand, ensures that the message is clearly understood by the recipient, leading to the desired response or action. It involves attributes that enhance clarity, impact, and reception of the message.

While communication is about transmitting information, effective communication focuses on ensuring that the information is received and understood as intended.

Effective Communication



- Effective communication is a process through which the sender conveys a message that the receiver readily receives and **understands**. It is a two-way process instead of a one-way process.
- A **two-way** information sharing process which involves one party sending a message that is easily **understood** by the receiving party.
- Effective communication is the process through which a message is passed to the intended recipient, and it is **understood** by him or her, thus eliciting the required response. It involves the use of **body language**, **gestures**, **listening skills** and **emotional awareness**.



Why **Learn** Effective Communication?

- The ability to communicate effectively is an **art** that can be used in many areas of your life, from employment and education to parenting and relationships. An effective communicator takes into account the audience or listener receiving the message and communicates accordingly.

How to Communicate Effectively?

1- Effectively Communicating Your Message To effectively communicate a message, you must understand how a receiver will process your message. It is important to include visuals, auditory effects as well as kinesthetic information (the interpretation of body language such as facial expressions and gestures – or, more formally, non-verbal behavior related to movement, either of any part of the body or the body as a whole) to appeal to the widest range of listeners.



2- Knowing Your Audience If you want to know details about your audience, send out a survey asking specific questions about age, interests, type of job performed, whether a parent or not. This information can assist you with formulating the message you will be sharing.

3- Paying Attention to Nonverbal Cues Effective communication means also paying attention to the nonverbal cues of the receiver. People who are listening attentively will often give you eye contact or a gesture such as a smile or a nod of the head to let you know they are listening.

4- Removing Barriers to Communication

Remove barriers to communicating your message. For example, do not think about what happened right before you arrived to speak, whether it is a flat tyre or whether you received bad news. Focus all of your attention on the receiver and deliver the message in a way that he will understand.

ELEMENTS OF COMMUNICATION



*For effective communication to take place, the following elements **MUST** be present:*



Sender: The sender initiates communication



Message: The message is what the sender communicates to the receiver



Channel: This is the means used to transmit the message from the sender to the receiver.



Receiver – the recipient of the message -



Feedback: this is the response the sender gets from the receiver

STAGES IN THE COMMUNICATION PROCESS



STAGE 1:

CONCEIVING THE MESSAGE



- The first stage in the communication process is the decision made by a sender to communicate a message, such as a **scream of fright or gasp of pain**. Others are the result of an impulse which occurs so quickly that the sender is barely conscious of having decided to stay or do anything.

STAGE 2: ENCODING THE MESSAGE



- Before the message is sent to the recipient, the sender needs to **encode** it in an appropriate language. The language may take the form of a **gesture** or a carefully **written** letter or report. It may also take the form of a **picture, symbol or non-verbal expression**.
- The languages of communication include the following: - The spoken word (oral) - The written word - The number - The picture, drawing or symbol or - The non-verbal communication – expression, gesture – Posture
- When the sender is ready with the message, then it is ready for transmission (sending the message).
- Therefore, it is up to the sender to make sure that the message accurately **reflects** what is intended and is then presented in the most suitable format.
- **Clarity** of purpose, message and delivery are essential elements of effective communication.

STAGE 3:

SELECTING THE COMMUNICAITON CHANNEL



- A channel is a **vehicle/medium** by which the message is passed on to the audience. For you to select/choose an appropriate channel, ask yourself:
- **Am I going to communicate by use of words, pictures or both?**
- **Which medium would be the most appreciated by the audience – written or spoken, a letter or personal chat?**
- Once the language has been chosen, the sender needs to select a medium through which to transmit the message. The choice of medium depends upon a number of, sometimes quite complicated factors. If the message is disciplinary, then a formal, private interview may be required.
- Some messages must be **written** – contracts are an obvious example – and geographical distance may require that the message is transmitted in letter-form.
- Alternatively, the need for a quick exchange of attitudes and opinions may suggest a **meeting** as the best medium.



Once the sender has encoded and is ready to send the message, he/she has to choose the appropriate **medium/channel** to do this.

This could be the following: face-to-face – meetings, interviews, presentations, informal discussions etc; oral – using telephone, cell phone, voice mail, answering machines etc; written- using letters, memos, reports, forms, fax messages, text messages or e-mail etc; visual- using charts, tables, diagrams, slides, maps or notices etc.



The likely effect of a message upon its receiver will also influence the choice of medium.
Bad news, for example, is much better broken in a private interview than more impersonally in a letter

STAGE 4: DECODING THE MESSAGE.



- Before a message can be absorbed or acted upon, it first needs to be **understood**.
- Many messages are ineffective because the sender **failed** to realize that the language he had chosen was beyond the ability of his receiver to comprehend.
- Terms like '*burn it*' and '*jargon*' are frequently employed when someone has used inappropriate language.

Some of the reasons for failure by a receiver to decode a message successfully are:



Interpreting the Message: the receiver ensures that he/she understands the underlying as well as the explicit meaning e.g. a received message may conceal a hidden meaning – meaning – message to be **read ‘between the lines**. The receiver must interpret the message correctly as **intended** by the sender.

1. The receiver does not share the **sender’s language**
2. The sender’s jargon (words or phrases) is **unknown** to the receiver. When we used words, we should always remember the following:
 - Words mean **different** things to different people
 - Words mean **different** things to the same person at different times
3. The sender is a specialist and the receiver is layman
4. Education, cultural pursuits and outlooks create a language block between sender and receiver.
5. Put yourself in his or her position. Try to ascertain your receiver’s abilities and limitations.
6. Avoid vagueness or ambiguity.
7. Check that you are receiving the desired feedback – answers, confirmations, indications or attitudes.

AS A RECEIVER:



- 1. Give the incoming message all your **attention**. Avoid being side-tracked or distracted
- 2. Check that the sender's chosen communication medium is meeting your needs. Help the sender to put his message across effectively by letting him know if the medium is inappropriate.
- 3. Ensure that you comprehend the message fully. **Seek confirming** feedback from the sender if the message is not clear by asking for explanations or repeats.
- 5. Provide the sender with **sufficient feedback**. Reassure him that you have received and understood the message.

FEEDBACK



- It is important that the receiver **sends feedback** to the sender.
- This could be in the form of **signals** passed to the sender – eg. Written reply, spoken word or person to person communication.
- By sending back the feedback, **the process starts again.**
- There are quite a number of problems that may occur at different stages during the process, and it is important to know this. They include:
 - **Message ill-conceived/vague/ambiguous**
 - **Message encoded in wrong language, inappropriate tone**
 - **Use of wrong medium, time wasting, expensive, no written record**
 - **Receiver unable to comprehend sender's language, use of jargon/vocabulary unfamiliar to receiver**
 - **Message wrongly interpreted, poor relationship between receiver and sender**
 - **Feedback not given or interpreted wrongly**

Noise

- **Noise** or interference (barriers) in different stages can affect the delivery of the message.
- This can interfere with the encoding and decoding stages.
- Any kind of interruption that distracts or distorts the message from being understood correctly or clearly is considered as noise. E.g. dressing, religious, affiliations, aroma or even stench.



Importance of Feedback



In general, we can quantify the following importance of feedback in communication, either in a formal or informal setting:

1. It completes the whole process of communication and makes it continuous.

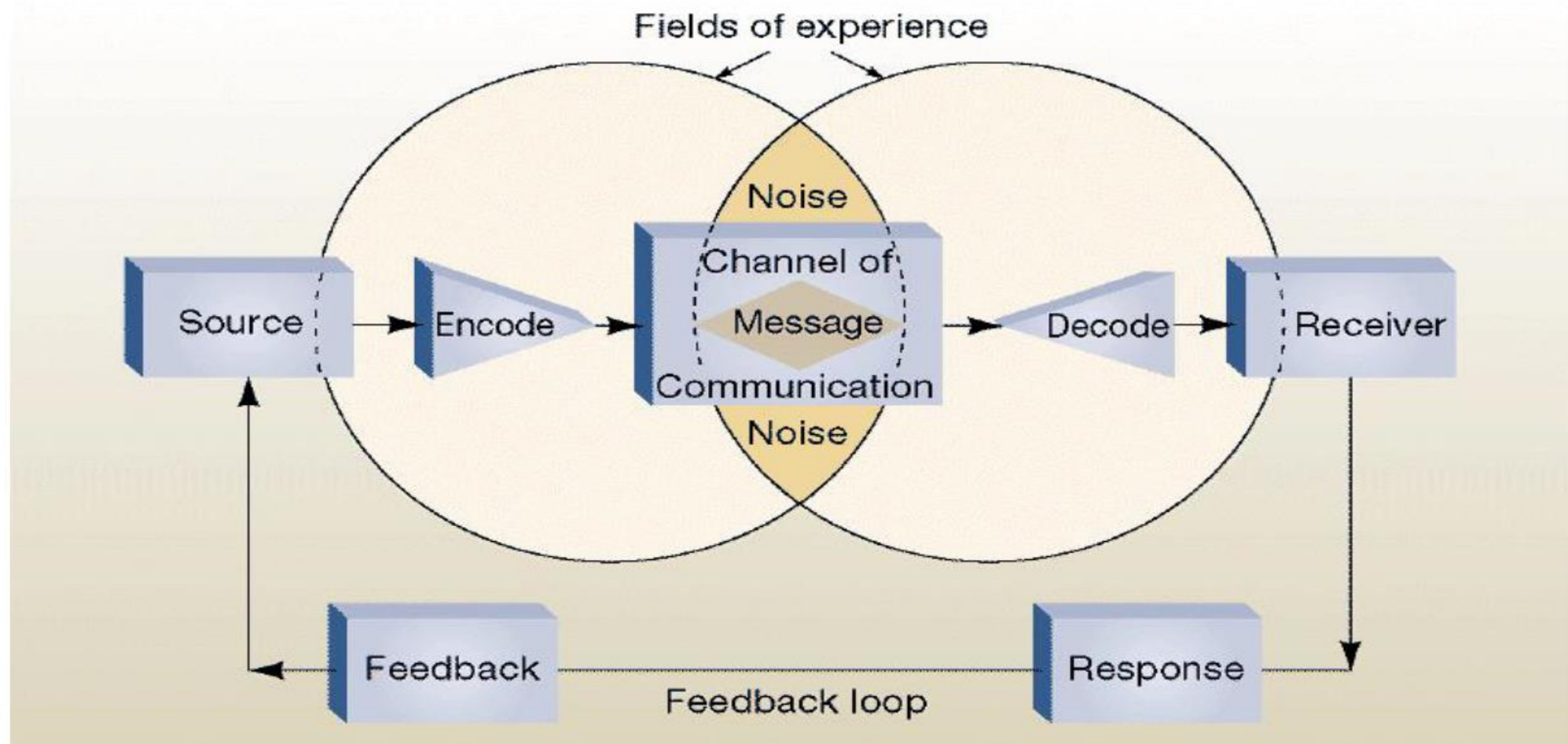
2. It sustains communication process

3. It makes one know if one is really communicating or making sense

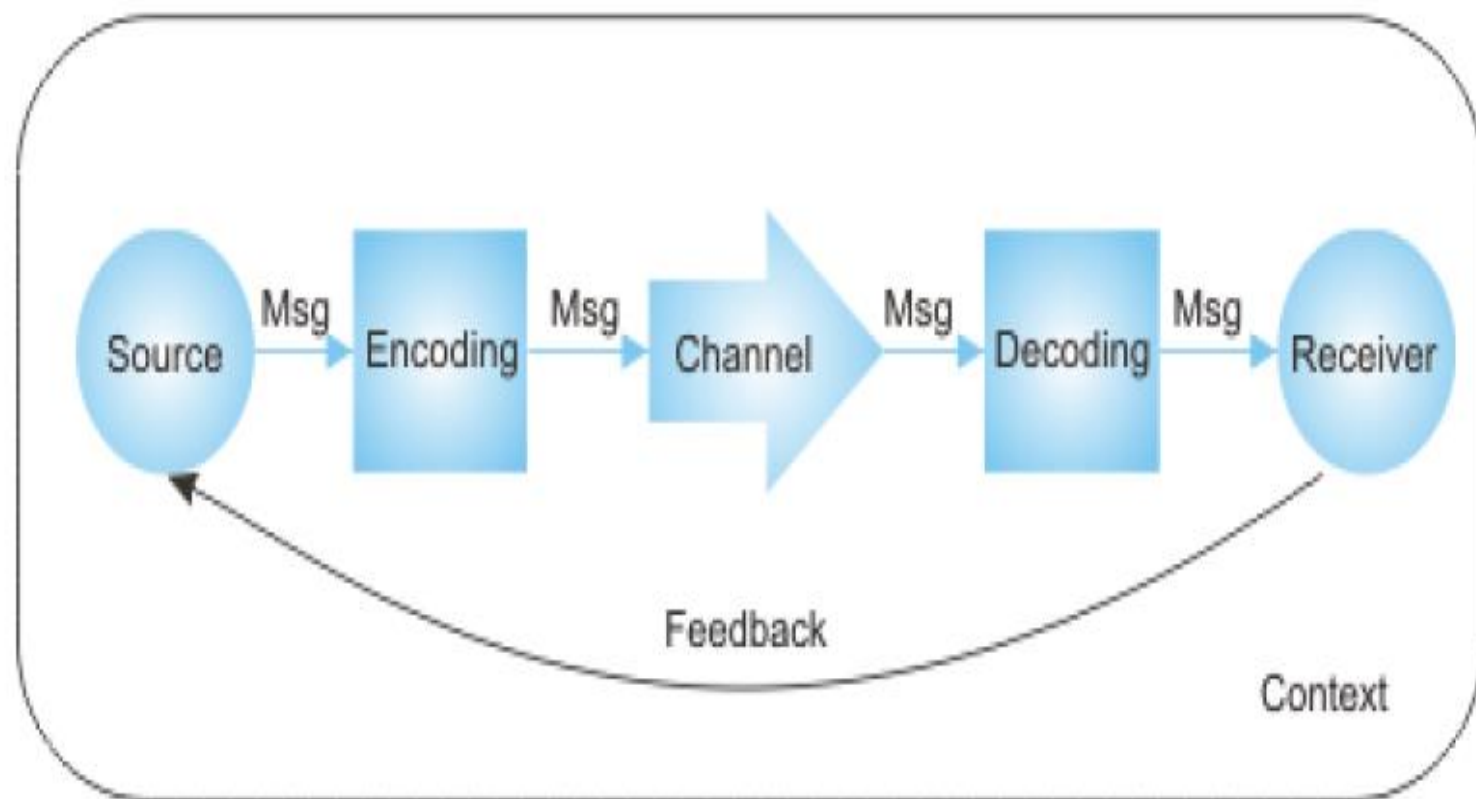
4. It is a basis for measuring the effectiveness of communication

5. It is a good basis for planning on what next to be done especially statistical report

6. Communication will be useless without feedback



The Communications Process



SUMMARY

In summary we note that communication is a two-way process that takes place through several stages which include:



1. Conception of the message happens when an idea, thought or feeling is formulated in the mind of the sender as a result of an external or internal stimulus or due to motivation. At this stage, the sender decides on the nature of the message.



2. Encoding of the message involves giving the message a communication form. This may be verbal or non-verbal.



3. Channel – the sender selects the most appropriate and effective vehicle that will deliver the message to the receiver. The media may include telephone, fax, letter, mouth etc.



4. Transmission: the message is transferred to the receiver through the selected channel. At this stage, there is possibility of the message being interfered with by “noise”



5. Reception: this is the physical act of receiving the message through any of the six senses – the sense of hearing, touch, taste, sight and smell.



6. Decoding: This is done by relating the language to the knowledge of terms and vocabulary. Comprehension takes place when the receiver tries to spend moments to absorb the meaning and understand the technical jargon used by the sender.



7. Interpretation is similar to what is loosely termed as ‘reading between the lines’. This means that you as the receiver should search for the underlying meaning.



8. Feedback: The message is encoded and a response is given in a language that the sender can understand. The communication process is then complete when the message is transmitted back to the sender. The receiver goes through the same communication process as the sender had done. Only when this cycle is completed, can communication be said to have been effective.